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My Brain Won't Let Me Start.

The ADHD-friendly reset for the woman
who's tired of feeling lazy.

START HERE

You're not lazy. Your brain just runs on different rules.

You know exactly what to do. You want to do it. And still you sit there, frozen — then crash into a guilt spiral about why you "can't just do the thing." Sound familiar?

That gap between knowing and doing isn't a character flaw. It's how an ADHD-style brain works: it needs interest, urgency, novelty, or a tiny first step — not more willpower. "Try harder" was never the answer because effort was never the problem.

WHAT THIS IS

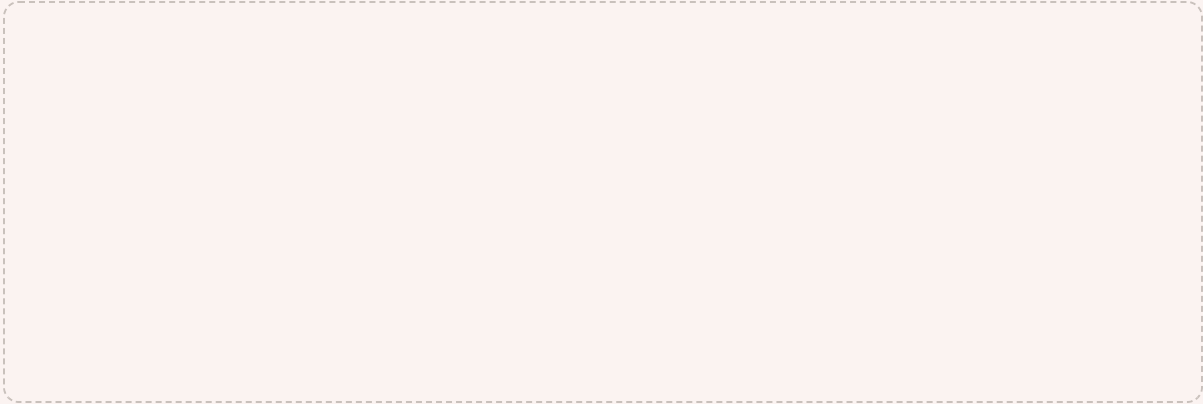
Tools built for YOUR brain — to beat task paralysis, pick what matters, and actually start (and finish) without the shame.

STEP 1

Dump it, then pick ONE

An ADHD brain sees the whole list at once — and freezes. So empty it out, then hide all of it but one.

Everything swirling in my head:



NOW CIRCLE JUST ONE

Today, I only owe myself ONE.

STEP 2

The 2-minute start ritual

Starting is the hardest part for us — so make starting almost embarrassingly easy.

- 1 **Shrink it til it's silly.** Not "do laundry" — "carry the basket to the machine." The goal is motion, not finishing.

- 2 **Set a 10-minute timer.** Tell yourself you can quit when it rings. You usually won't — starting was the wall.

- 3 **Body-double.** Do it next to someone (in person or on video), or narrate it out loud. Accountability tricks the brain into gear.

- 4 **Stack a reward.** Coffee, a song, a show — *after* the timer. Give your brain the dopamine it's hunting for.

STEP 3

Make the task ADHD-proof

Boring tasks don't get done — not because you're weak, but because your brain needs a hook. Add one:

- **Pair it.** Match a dull task with a podcast, music, or a phone call. Never just the boring thing alone.
- **Make it visible.** Out of sight = out of mind for ADHD. Use one sticky note, one whiteboard, one open tab — not twelve.
- **Add novelty.** New spot, new pen, race the timer. Newness wakes the brain up.
- **Borrow urgency.** "I'll do it before the kettle boils." Tiny deadlines beat someday.
- **Lower the bar.** A messy done beats a perfect never. B-minus is a finish line.

If a system is boring, your brain will quietly delete it. Keep it visible, novel, and stupidly simple.

STEP 4

Where does the time go?

Time blindness is real. You can't feel time passing — so put it outside your head where you can see it.

- **Use a visible timer / clock.** Watch the minutes move. Don't trust your inner clock — it lies.
- **Alarms for transitions, not just events.** "10 minutes till we leave" is the alarm that saves you.
- **Add a buffer.** Whatever you think it'll take, add half again. You're not slow — you underestimate.
- **One "launch pad" spot.** Keys, bag, charger live in ONE place by the door. End the daily search.

My one launch-pad spot will be:

Your brain isn't broken.

Say them until you believe them:

- I'm not lazy. I have a brain that needs different tools.
- A messy, late, done thing still counts.
- Struggling to start is not a moral failure.
- I can be proud of small wins without shrinking them.
- I'll work with my brain, not against it.

The ONE thing I'm starting today (2-minute version):

A practical self-help tool, not a diagnosis or medical advice.

Don't do the list. Do the next two minutes.

Shrink it, start it, reward it. You were never lazy — you just needed tools that fit your brain. Now you have them. Go start your one thing.

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